Drama at A4E lobbying event

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【要点】

・Ryanair のマイケル・オレアリーCEOが、ルフトハンザとエールフランス・KLMによる同社の所有支配構造に対する法的異議に対抗するため、A4E航空業界ロビー団から年末までに脱退すると脅迫した。

・A4E加盟航空会社のCEOらはEU気候政策の批判で共通している一方、英国のEU復帰やブレグジット問題では見解が相違している。

・航空各社は、英国の航空旅客税の引き上げ凍結をロンドンに要求することで一致しており、増税は航空路線の接続性とチケット価格に悪影響を与える可能性があると懸念している。

・来週のヨーロッパ理事会では、船舶セキュリティ、軍事モビリティ、北極地域への強靭性がEU指導者の議題に登ることが予定されている。

【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By MARTINA SAPIO with JORDYN DAHL and TOMMASO LECCA SNEAK PEEK — Ryanair threat

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure.

By MARTINA SAPIO

with JORDYN DAHL and TOMMASO LECCA

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SNEAK PEEK

— Ryanair threatened to leave airline lobby A4E over a legal challenge to its ownership structure that was backed by Lufthansa and Air France-KLM.

— Next week’s European Council is set to put shipping security, military mobility and Arctic resilience on EU leaders’ agenda, according to draft summit conclusions.

— The debate over the IAA in Parliament goes beyond the dispute among member countries as groupings put award rafts of amendments.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

Tips to jdahl@politico.eu , tlecca@politico.eu and msapio@politico.eu . Follow us @tommylecca , @jordyndahl and @martsapio .

Mark your calendars: Our weekly mobility calendar landed in your inbox on Thursday. You can also go online to export and plan your week or suggest your own event.

DRIVING THE DAY

AIRLINE LOBBY RISKS SPLITTING OVER RYANAIR: Airlines for Europe lobby could soon lose its most vocal member. Ryanair's Michael O'Leary, speaking Thursday at an A4E press conference, said he would quit the lobby group by the end of the year unless Lufthansa and Air France-KLM drop a legal case in which they claim that the Irish airline doesn't meet EU ownership and control rules.

"This is the end of A4E," O'Leary told a group of reporters after the A4E press conference. "Either Air France and Lufthansa will agree to go … and if they stay, then we will go, probably before the end of the year," he added.

Common interest: "While members may have differing views on certain issues, we share a common interest in advancing our collective work for the benefit of European passengers, particularly in an increasingly complex and costly regulatory environment," said an A4E spokesperson after the press conference, during which airline CEOs spent much of their time criticizing EU climate policies. Tommaso has more .

A4Exit: The ownership and control dispute wasn't the only issue dividing the CEOs. Asked if they'd welcome the U.K. rejoining the EU, Lufthansa's Carsten Spohr responded with an emphatic "yes," while O'Leary disagreed. "We have had enough of the psycho drama of the U.K. and Europe and Brexit," the Ryanair CEO added, expressing concerns about the ability of the pro-EU camp to win a potential referendum. EasyJet's Kenton Jarvis called for a "closer cooperation" between Brussels and London.

Still on the U.K.: Despite their differences, airline chiefs agreed on the need to ask London to freeze any increase in the U.K.'s air passenger duty in the next budget. "The reality is, unless it's frozen, I think there is a risk to connectivity," Jarvis said, referring to the possibility of higher ticket prices.

Fuel prices: Another shared concern is the outlook for jet fuel prices, which could remain elevated into 2027, when many airlines' existing fuel hedges are due to expire.

IAG CEO Luis Gallego told Tommaso that experts expect "fuel prices are going to continue high for a period of time" even after oil shipments through the Strait of Hormuz resume. If the jet fuel prices remain at current levels, airlines will have to raise ticket prices. "You don't have any other alternative because you're going to lose a lot of money," he added.

EUROPEAN COUNCIL

EUCO'S TRANSPORT TO-DO LIST: Next week's European Council is set to put shipping security, military mobility and Arctic resilience high on leaders' agenda, according to draft summit conclusions obtained by POLITICO.

Black Sea first: Leaders are expected to call for the immediate restoration of safe passage for grain ships in the Black Sea, while condemning Russian attacks on Ukrainian ports, vessels, border crossings and export infrastructure. The language lands after two merchant ships were struck by drones in Bulgaria's exclusive economic zone this week, with one vessel sinking and its 12 crew members still missing after Sofia halted the rescue operation.

Hormuz and the Red Sea: Leaders are also set to condemn acts that block commercial vessels from entering or leaving the Strait of Hormuz and insist that any arrangement governing the chokepoint must respect international law and freedom of navigation. On the Red Sea, leaders are expected to demand an end to Houthi attacks on civilian shipping and call for the EU's Aspides naval mission to be reinforced.

Military mobility: On land, leaders want Parliament and Council negotiators to finish the EU's military mobility regulation by year-end — adding top-level political pressure to a file designed to make it faster to move troops and equipment across Europe. The next trilogue is set for Oct. 20, as we reported last week, with a final negotiating round penciled in for Dec. 9.

And the money: Leaders are also due to discuss the next long-term EU budget and ask European Council President António Costa to reach a deal by the end of the year — important context for transport, given that many of the infrastructure, military mobility and resilience projects depend on EU funding.

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MARITIME

GREECE AND A STRAIT OF HORMUZ MISSION: There has been no official request from the United States for Greek participation in any new mission in the Strait of Hormuz, a senior Greek government official said Thursday, our colleague Nektaria Stamouli reports. U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio was in Athens on Wednesday.

Athens' view: "The Greek side has made it clear that it is willing to provide assistance, which could include the provision of infrastructure, subject to two basic conditions: that conditions of peace prevail and that there is consensus among the parties concerned, so as to ensure the safety of Greek personnel," the official added.

TRUCKS

TRUCKERS AND GREENS TEAM UP ON CHARGING: The International Road Transport Union and green NGO Transport & Environment are jointly pushing Brussels to create a new category of "semi-private" truck charging in the upcoming review of the EU's Alternative Fuels Infrastructure Regulation , according to a letter sent on Thursday to Commissioners Teresa Ribera and Apostolos Tzitzikostas and obtained by POLITICO.

What does that mean? Charging stations at truck depots, warehouses and logistics hubs are primarily built for a company's own vehicles but they could be opened to subcontractors or other operators when capacity is available. The letter argues those chargers should not have to operate under the same rules as fully public charging stations, provided companies retain control over who gets access and can prioritize their own fleets.

The Brussels ask: The two groups want the AFIR review to formally recognize the new category, clarify that logistics companies sharing chargers do not automatically become public charging operators or electricity suppliers, simplify permitting and grid connections, and make semi-private chargers eligible for EU and national funding and state aid.

INDUSTRIAL ACCELERATOR ACT

PARLIAMENT'S IAA AMENDMENTS: The biggest fight on the Industrial Accelerator Act at the member state level is over which countries will be defined as "Made in Europe." But different battles are brewing in Parliament based on amendments from political groupings obtained by POLITICO.

Green, please: Rather than basing the Made in Europe definition on trade relationships, the liberal Renew group wants that status linked to commitments on energy and climate. Eligible countries should be “full members of the International Energy Agency” and “party to the Paris Agreement,” the group writes in its amendments . Meanwhile, the Greens and the Socialists and Democrats spell out additional environmental, labor and human-rights conditions for partner-country content.

Foreign investment screening: The Commission proposes that foreign direct investment must meet four of six criteria, including limited foreign ownership and technology transfers and joint ventures. Renew wants to tighten the approval test so authorities “shall only approve” investments that fulfill all of the six conditions. S&D also wants to extend screening to investors or their subsidiaries and proposes moving the rules’ start date forward. The Greens are pushing for lower ownership and screening thresholds.

Permitting: The IAA’s aim is to speed up permitting. But here, too, the groups have different approaches. Renew would exempt certain cleaner industrial projects from a nitrogen assessment where they “result in a structural reduction of nitrogen emissions.” S&D supports streamlined processes but wants fast-track status conditional on decarbonization. The Greens take a more restrictive environmental approach.

The case of the EPP: While the European People’s Party made the headline for an amendment filed by three MEPs calling for the suppression of the proposal, Spanish MEP Raúl de la Hoz Quintano filed 111 amendments seeking a tighter definition of Made in EU that would include content from “the European Union, the European Economic Area (EEA), the European Free Trade Association (EFTA) and the United Kingdom.” On the other topics, his approach is to make industrial permitting easier, while making foreign-investment screening more targeted and workable.

Far-right group: The Europe of Sovereign Nations Parliamentary group filed 10 amendments to make permitting fasters.

Headlines

Here’s a recap of yesterday’s news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Germany wants UK to raise tariffs on Chinese EVs
Berlin wants the measure as a condition of a Made in Europe opt-out for the U.K.
By Jon Stone · Oct 08, 2026, 04:15 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

China trade talks test EU’s appetite for tougher action
Trade Commissioner Maroš Šefčovič is seeking concessions from Beijing to narrow a record trade deficit, but expectations of a breakthrough are low.
By Camille Gijs, Carlo Martuscelli · Oct 08, 2026, 04:05 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Weekly Calendar

Here’s a selection of upcoming key events, find the complete Week Ahead online.

SESAR Annual Conference
Oct 12, 2026, 9:30 AM - 6:00 pm · Brussels, BE

Eurocontrol Standing Committee on Finance
Oct 12, 2026, 1:00 PM - Oct 13, 2026, 1:30 PM · Brussels, BE

World Aviation Festival
Oct 13, 2026 - Oct 15, 2026 · Lisbon, PT

Council Working Party on Land Transport
Oct 13, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Council Working Party on Space
Oct 13, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Sommet sur la Compétitivité Économique 2026
Oct 13, 2026, 9:00 AM - 5:30 pm

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EUROCONTROL 'ECAC/EU Dialogue with the European air transport industry' Event
Oct 13, 2026, 9:00 AM - Oct 14, 2026, 5:00 PM · Paris, FR

The European Automotive Balancing Act
Oct 13, 2026, 5:30 PM - 8:00 pm

POLITICO x Netflix screening "The Diplomat" Season 4
Oct 13, 2026, 6:30 PM - Oct 14, 2026, 9:00 PM

Coreper I
Oct 14, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Council Working Party on Transport (Intermodal Questions and Networks)
Oct 14, 2026 · Brussels, BE

European Resilience Summit 2026
Oct 14, 2026, 9:00 AM - 5:00 pm

Eurocontrol 'Local Single Sky Implementation+' event
Oct 14, 2026, 11:00 AM - Oct 15, 2026, 7:00 AM · Brussels, BE

IATA Wings of Change Europe
Oct 15, 2026 · Brussels, BE

European Council
Oct 15, 2026 - Oct 16, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Pro Roundtable – Competition and Industrial Policy
Oct 15, 2026, 8:15 AM - 10:00 am

Pro Roundtable – Defense UK

Oct 15, 2026, 9:00 AM - 11:00 am

Eurocontrol ‘President Bureau 19’ Event
Oct 15, 2026, 9:00 AM - 3:00 pm · Brussels, BE

Pro Intelligence Connections
2021/0223(COD) Deployment of alternative fuels inf…
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